

Cover Letter — Director, AI Operations

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/russelldudek
<https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>

Dear Ontra Hiring Team,

The central challenge in this role is not generating more AI activity. It is turning distributed demand, experiments, tools, and enthusiasm into adopted workflow change that the next team can trust. That requires one mechanism connecting roadmap choices, hands-on implementation, retained human authority, practical governance, enablement, and measurable evidence.

That is the through-line of my work. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, purchasing, support, customer success, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, standard work, training, and accountability. Through DudeWorth, I build AI-readiness and agentic-workflow patterns that explicitly connect value, feasibility, data readiness, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, governance, and adoption. Earlier, I built operating cadence, visibility, and launch mechanisms at Amazon and quality, process-control, and technical-translation systems at Compunetics.

My candidate thesis

Turn each AI intervention into a precedent the next team can trust.

A useful precedent does more than document an automation. It records the work changed, the value sought, the human authority retained, the data and tool boundaries, the adoption mechanism, the evidence required, and the accountable owner. That makes governance operational rather than ornamental—and makes successful local work easier to adapt without pretending every department is identical.

I created an independent candidate vision for this role at <https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>. It includes the interactive AI Operating Precedent, a role-specific decision model, verified transfer evidence, and a 120-day entry plan. The work is intentionally framed as hypotheses for discovery rather than claims about Ontra's internal state.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how Ontra currently qualifies AI demand, defines human authority, builds local advocates, measures retained adoption, and decides what should become company-wide precedent.

Carpe diem,

Russell Dudek